

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 46)

Page 227 - E.B. Browning and Rossetti

Q1. Which long poem in blank verse by Elizabeth Barrett Browning might really be classed as a novel, save for its form?

- A. The Cry of the Children
- B. Casa Guidi Windows
- C. Aurora Leigh
- D. Sonnets from the Portuguese

Answer: C

Q2. Unlike Matthew Arnold, Mrs. Browning believed that it should be one chief aim of the poet to:

- A. Imitate Greek tragedies
- B. Meet the age face to face
- C. Escape completely into the past
- D. Write only in Latin

Answer: B

Q3. In which series of sonnets did Mrs. Browning enshrine her love, creating a masterpiece of love-poetry?

- A. The House of Life
- B. Sonnets from the Portuguese
- C. Modern Love
- D. Astrophil and Stella

Answer: B

Q4. Dante Gabriel Rossetti is the leading figure in which artistic movement?

- A. Pre-Raphaelitism
- B. Imagism
- C. The Spasmodic School
- D. The Lake School

Answer: A

Q5. How is Dante Gabriel Rossetti described in relation to his time, using Mr. Hall Caine's language?

- A. A progressive visionary
- B. An anachronism in these days
- C. A scientific rationalist
- D. The voice of Victorian industry

Answer: B

Q6. The real home of Rossetti's imagination was not 19th-century London, but:

- A. Ancient Rome
- B. The Florence of Dante's era
- C. Medieval Paris
- D. The Scottish Highlands

Answer: B

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Q7. Despite the deeply Catholic atmosphere of his poetry, what were Rossetti's actual intellectual convictions?

- A. He was a devout Catholic
- B. He was an evangelical Protestant
- C. He was an agnostic
- D. He was a staunch Puritan

Answer: C

Q8. In which poetic form did Rossetti excel when dealing with situations of tragic intensity?

- A. The dramatic monologue
- B. The blank verse epic
- C. The ballad
- D. The mock-heroic

Answer: C

Q9. Which of the following is a poem by Dante Gabriel Rossetti?

- A. The Blessed Damozel
- B. Aurora Leigh
- C. Casa Guidi Windows
- D. Sordello

Answer: A

Q10. How is Rossetti's poetry as a whole characterized in terms of its tone?

- A. Highly moral and religiously orthodox
- B. Racy and full-blooded
- C. Not very wholesome, with a rare and exotic beauty suggestive of decadence
- D. Completely plain and unadorned

Answer: C

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Page 228 - Christina Rossetti, Morris, and Swinburne

Q1. Who is the only other woman-poet in this literature who can fairly be placed beside Mrs. Browning?

- A. Emily Bronte
- B. Christina Georgina Rossetti
- C. George Eliot
- D. Felicia Hemans

Answer: B

Q2. Christina Rossetti's work is characterized by:

- A. Satirical humor and political commentary
- B. Deep religious feeling, a pronounced strain of mysticism, and much metrical charm
- C. Cold classicism and objective epic forms
- D. Detailed descriptions of industrial life

Answer: B

Q3. Through which poet is the main line of Rossetti's influence and romanticism traced?

- A. Algernon Charles Swinburne
- B. Matthew Arnold
- C. William Morris
- D. James Thomson

Answer: C

Q4. Which of the following is an early work by William Morris?

- A. The Earthly Paradise
- B. Atalanta in Calydon
- C. The White Ship
- D. Sister Helen

Answer: A

Q5. Under the influence of Ruskin and a revulsion from modern commercialism, what political ideology did William Morris adopt?

- A. Conservatism
- B. Socialism
- C. Anarchism
- D. Imperialism

Answer: B

Q6. How did Morris once describe himself early in his career?

- A. A scorpion
- B. The idle singer of an empty day
- C. The poetic exponent of liberalism
- D. A wandering minstrel

Answer: B

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Q7. Which poet was the last to die of the great race of Victorian poets?

- A. Robert Browning
- B. Lord Tennyson
- C. Algernon Charles Swinburne
- D. William Morris

Answer: C

Q8. Swinburne's 'Atalanta in Calydon' and 'Erechtheus' rank among the finest attempts to revive which form?

- A. The medieval mystery play
- B. The English sonnet sequence
- C. The pure classic form of Greek tragedy
- D. The Italian epic

Answer: C

Q9. Swinburne wrote an English dramatic trilogy about which historical figure?

- A. Mary Stuart
- B. Queen Elizabeth
- C. Joan of Arc
- D. Cleopatra

Answer: A

Q10. The revolutionary fervor of Swinburne's political poems is strongly suggestive of which of his chief masters?

- A. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- B. Lord Byron
- C. Victor Hugo
- D. Charles Baudelaire

Answer: C

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Page 229 - Swinburne and Minor Poets

Q1. It is primarily as what type of poet that Swinburne will hold his place in our literature?

- A. An epic poet
- B. A dramatist
- C. A lyrist
- D. A satirist

Answer: C

Q2. What was a frequent snare for Swinburne in his poetry?

- A. His excessive political conservatism
- B. His fondness for mere verbal effects
- C. His inability to write in meter
- D. His strict adherence to realism

Answer: B

Q3. Which of the following works is a romantic comedy by Sir Henry Taylor?

- A. Philip van Artevelde
- B. The Virgin Widow, or A Sicilian Summer
- C. The Quest of the Sangraal
- D. Proverbial Philosophy

Answer: B

Q4. Robert Stephen Hawker was the extremely eccentric vicar of Morwenstow in which English county?

- A. Devon
- B. Yorkshire
- C. Cornwall
- D. Kent

Answer: C

Q5. What is considered Robert Stephen Hawker's finest poem, full of the genuine spirit of medieval adventure?

- A. The Quest of the Sangraal
- B. Idylls of the King
- C. The Earthly Paradise
- D. Tristram of Lyonesse

Answer: A

Q6. Who produced the famous free translation, or paraphrase, of the Rubaiyat of Omar Khayyam?

- A. Sir Henry Taylor
- B. Robert Stephen Hawker
- C. Edward FitzGerald
- D. Martin Farquhar Tupper

Answer: C

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Q7. In which century did the original Persian astronomer-poet, Omar Khayyam, live?

- A. The ninth century
- B. The eleventh century
- C. The thirteenth century
- D. The fifteenth century

Answer: B

Q8. Did Edward FitzGerald's translation of the Rubaiyat achieve immediate success?

- A. Yes, it was an instant bestseller
- B. No, it had little success at first, but gradually won its way
- C. It was completely ignored until the 20th century
- D. It was banned upon publication

Answer: B

Q9. Who was the author of the highly didactic collection 'Proverbial Philosophy'?

- A. Martin Farquhar Tupper
- B. Edward FitzGerald
- C. Robert Stephen Hawker
- D. Sir Henry Taylor

Answer: A

Q10. What is the current critical standing of 'Proverbial Philosophy', despite selling by the hundred thousand in its day?

- A. It is still a widely read classic
- B. It is relegated to the dust-heap of unread things
- C. It is celebrated as the pinnacle of Victorian philosophy
- D. It is studied closely for its metrical innovations

Answer: B

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Page 230 - The Spasmodic School and Other Minor Poets

Q1. Upon which enormous poem does Philip James Bailey's reputation rest?

- A. The Earthly Paradise
- B. Festus
- C. The Roman
- D. Balder

Answer: B

Q2. 'Festus' was commonly regarded as the principal agency in fostering which school of poetry?

- A. The Lake School
- B. The Pre-Raphaelite Brotherhood
- C. The Spasmodic School
- D. The Parnassian School

Answer: C

Q3. How did Tennyson sum up Philip James Bailey's 'Festus'?

- A. As the greatest poem of the century
- B. As a dull poem containing many grand things
- C. As completely devoid of merit
- D. As an exact copy of 'Paradise Lost'

Answer: B

Q4. Which two writers are given as examples of exploded reputations from the spasmodic school?

- A. Dante Gabriel Rossetti and William Morris
- B. Sydney Dobell and Alexander Smith
- C. Matthew Arnold and Arthur Hugh Clough
- D. James Thomson and Edward FitzGerald

Answer: B

Q5. James Thomson is known for which poem of pessimism and blank despair?

- A. Balder
- B. Life Drama
- C. The City of Dreadful Night
- D. The Roman

Answer: C

Q6. Lord Macaulay won fame with which stirring work of poetry?

- A. Lost Tales of Miletus
- B. Lays of Ancient Rome
- C. King Arthur
- D. The Spanish Gypsy

Answer: B

Q7. Which versatile author wrote the romantic epic 'King Arthur' and 'Lost Tales of Miletus'?

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- A. Lord Macaulay
- B. Lord Lytton
- C. Thackeray
- D. Kingsley

Answer: B

Q8. The author notes that George Eliot's poetry is considerable in quantity, but lacking in what?

- A. Intellectual qualities
- B. Moral qualities
- C. Real poetic inspiration
- D. Correct grammar

Answer: C

Q9. Which of the following is a poetic work by George Eliot?

- A. The Legend of Jubal
- B. The Saint's Tragedy
- C. Andromeda
- D. Life Drama

Answer: A

Q10. Charles Kingsley's poetic works, which leave readers regretting there is so little of it, include which two notable pieces?

- A. The Saint's Tragedy and Andromeda
- B. The Spanish Gypsy and Agatha
- C. King Arthur and Lays of Ancient Rome
- D. The Roman and Balder

Answer: A

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Page 231 - The Age of Tennyson: Carlyle

Q1. Who is described as incomparably the greatest figure in the general prose literature of his age?

- A. John Ruskin
- B. Thomas Carlyle
- C. Matthew Arnold
- D. Lord Macaulay

Answer: B

Q2. In what year was Thomas Carlyle born?

- A. 1795
- B. 1800
- C. 1809
- D. 1812

Answer: A

Q3. What was the occupation of Thomas Carlyle's father?

- A. A clergyman
- B. A stonemason
- C. A schoolmaster
- D. A wealthy landowner

Answer: B

Q4. Thomas Carlyle sprang straight from the rugged peasantry of which country?

- A. Ireland
- B. Wales
- C. Scotland
- D. England

Answer: C

Q5. Which strict religious doctrine in which he was bred left a lasting impression on Carlyle's mind?

- A. Methodism
- B. Roman Catholicism
- C. The old Calvinism
- D. Anglicanism

Answer: C

Q6. At which university did Thomas Carlyle matriculate in 1809?

- A. Oxford University
- B. Cambridge University
- C. Edinburgh University
- D. Glasgow University

Answer: C

Q7. What was Carlyle's parents' original design for his career?

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- A. That he should become a doctor
- B. That he should enter the Scottish Church
- C. That he should be a lawyer
- D. That he should join the military

Answer: B

Q8. Why did Carlyle find it impossible to enter the Scottish Church?

- A. He lacked the necessary funds for training
- B. Radical changes in his religious views made it impossible
- C. He failed his university exams
- D. He was drafted into the army

Answer: B

Q9. What phrase is used to describe the period when Carlyle was striving vainly to recover his lost belief?

- A. The dark night of the soul
- B. The howling wilderness of infidelity
- C. The slough of despond
- D. The valley of the shadow of death

Answer: B

Q10. What ended Carlyle's years of doubt and restored him to a mood of courage and faith?

- A. A long conversation with his father
- B. A moment of mystical illumination, or 'spiritual new birth'
- C. Reading the works of John Stuart Mill
- D. A journey to Rome

Answer: B